



Meet Jay Jaganaath

The inspiring story of a class 12 kid in Faridabad is teaching orphaned children to code on MIT's Scratch <https://dgit.in/jul20-109>



Google Assistant devtools

Google has released a number of new tools that allow developers to add functionality to Google Assistant <https://dgit.in/jul20-110>

Is it really an upgrade?

Agent001 delves into the new AMD CPUs and chipsets

Agent001 | agent001@digit.in



O

ne of my pals was looking to upgrade his PC and was exploring his options. This is

usually when folks call me out of the blue to clarify their doubts. And I don't mind helping folks with their PC configurations, so it's always a pleasure. So my friend had heard about these new XT chips from AMD and wanted to know if it was worth upgrading to the new chips especially when they're being advertised for sale at the exact same price point as the non-XT chips. This was a fairly simple question and easily answered too. The price that was being advertised by AMD is the launch price. So the XT is launching at the same launch price as that of the non-XT components but the simple fact is that the non-XT components have been out for nearly a year and the street prices for these things have come down by a bit. When the XT chips do launch in the next couple of days, they will be priced slightly more than the non-XT chips and that makes perfect sense. The new XT chips are supposedly

better by a slight fraction and the street pricing would be only slightly higher than the non-XT parts. However, I advised him that things wouldn't be so cut and dry in Indian markets since computer components rarely sell anywhere close to their suggested retail pricing. Moreover, once you factor in the Covid-19 pandemic and how it has slowed down businesses, you'll experience even more unstable pricing. So while in the first world countries deciding

ence with the B550 chipset is that they make use of PCIe Gen 4 for the interconnects between the CPU and the storage and graphics. Also, USB ports coming out of the CPU are USB 3.1 Gen 2 instead of Gen 1 as was the case on the B450. So being a mid-range chip, you'd expect B550 to be cheap but when the pricing was announced, they turned out to be quite the shocker. Some B550 boards were more expensive than the X470 motherboards and a few come close to X570 motherboards. Compared to the X570 boards, with the B550 you don't get PCIe 4 from the chipset, so all interconnects

that are powered by the chipset are on PCIe 3.0. The reason why X570 boards were expensive and needed additional cooling on the chipset was that PCIe 4.0 was



between a XT and non-XT part might be painfully obvious, it won't be the same case here.

Once the processor was out of the way, came the motherboard. AMD had recently unveiled the B550 motherboard which are designed for mid-range configurations and meant to supersede the B450 motherboards that were launched with the 2nd Gen Ryzen processors. The key differ-

very taxing and ran hot. By doing away with PCIe 4.0 on the chipset, B550 boards run a little cooler and there's also the cost savings incurred as a result. One major drawback with the B550 chipset is the number of processor generations that it can support. The B450 chipset could support almost everything starting from the 1st Gen Ryzen to the latest 4th Gen Ryzen. B550 can only support 3rd